KI WOONG MOON

Department of Linguistics, University of Arizona
kiwoongmoon@arizona.edu — ki-woong95.github.io — GitHub

EDUCATION

University of Arizona, Tucson, Arizona, U.S.A. *Aug 2022 – Present*
Ph.D. in Linguistics, expected May 2027
Major: Phonetics; Minor: Computational Linguistics
Dissertation (working title): Speech Variability and Uncertainty: Human Production, Perception, and Computational Processing
Advisor: Dr. Natasha Warner

University of Arizona, Tucson, Arizona, U.S.A. *2025*
M.S. in Human Language Technology

Hankuk University of Foreign Studies, Seoul, South Korea *2022*
M.A. in English Linguistics
M.A. thesis: *Automatic Detection of Word-level Suprasegmental Speech Errors in EFL Utterance*
Advisor: Dr. Tae-Yeoub Jang

Hankuk University of Foreign Studies, Seoul, South Korea *2020*
B.A. in English

PUBLICATIONS AND MANUSCRIPTS

Ki Woong Moon & Natasha Warner. 2025. Realization of *just*: Speech reduction in a high-frequency word. *Proceedings of Meetings on Acoustics*, 56(1), 060005. doi:10.1121/2.0002080

Ki Woong Moon & Daniel Brenner. Does a prosody-trained representation help beyond trainable fusion? A parameter-matched study with frozen HuBERT. Submitted to *ICASSP 2027*. arXiv:2609.36754

Ki Woong Moon & Natasha Warner. Layer-wise accessibility of phonetic variation in spontaneous *just*. Submitted to the *21st International Congress of Phonetic Sciences (ICPhS 2027)*.

Ki Woong Moon & Natasha Warner. Just reduced: Gradient acoustic reduction in a high-frequency function word. Manuscript in preparation.

Natasha Warner, **Ki Woong Moon**, Seongjin Park, & James M. McQueen. Metrical segmentation and competition in native and cross-dialectal spoken word recognition. Manuscript in preparation.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

Ki Woong Moon & Natasha Warner. 2026. Context-dependent use of sibilant and vowel duration in the perception of reduced *just*. *191st Meeting of the Acoustical Society of America*, Baltimore, Maryland. Poster. (Accepted)

Ki Woong Moon & Daniel Brenner. 2026. Prosody or adaptation? Disentangling gains in frozen self-supervised learning for automatic speech recognition. *191st Meeting of the Acoustical Society of America*, Baltimore, Maryland. Poster. (Accepted)

Ki Woong Moon & Daniel Brenner. 2025. Enhancing HuBERT for spontaneous speech with acoustic feature fusion. *6th Joint Meeting of the Acoustical Society of America and Acoustical Society of Japan*. Honolulu, Hawaii. (Invited talk)

Ki Woong Moon & Natasha Warner. 2025. Realization of *just*: Speech reduction in a high-frequency word. *188th Meeting of the Acoustical Society of America*. New Orleans, Louisiana. (Poster)

Ki Woong Moon. 2024. Preceding word information for predicting speech errors in EFL speech. *LabPhon 19*. Seoul, South Korea. (Poster)

Ki Woong Moon. 2024. Preceding word information for predicting speech errors in EFL speech. *186th Meeting of the Acoustical Society of America*. Ottawa, Ontario, Canada. (Poster)

Natasha Warner, **Ki Woong Moon**, Seongjin Park, James M. McQueen, & Mohammed K. Albusairi. 2024. Metrical segmentation across dialects. *186th Meeting of the Acoustical Society of America*. Ottawa, Ontario, Canada. (Poster)

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

University of Arizona *Instructor of Record*
Department of Linguistics

LING/CSC/PSY 438 Computational Linguistics *Fall 2025, Fall 2026*
Designed and taught an upper-level course covering text processing, regular expressions, finite-state automata, Markov chains, formal grammars, syntactic parsing, and the Chomsky hierarchy, with programming in Perl, Python, and Prolog.

LING/CSC/DATA/ISTA 439 Statistical Natural Language Processing *Spring 2026*
Designed and taught an upper-level course covering machine learning fundamentals, word and phrase representations, sequence tagging, and structured prediction, including Naive Bayes, logistic regression, Hidden Markov models, embeddings, and dependency parsing.

LING 201 Introduction to Linguistics *Summer 2024, Summer 2025*
Taught an online introductory linguistics course covering phonetics, phonology, morphology, syntax, and semantics; developed weekly lectures, assignments, quizzes, and other course materials.

University of Arizona *Graduate Teaching Associate*
Department of Linguistics

LING 150A Language in the World *Spring 2025*
Supported instruction on linguistic diversity, language and society, language rights, and language endangerment and revitalization; graded coursework and held weekly office hours.

Hankuk University of Foreign Studies *Teaching Assistant*
Department of English Linguistics and Language Technology

Computational Linguistics *Spring 2021*
Supported undergraduate instruction in computational linguistics and Python programming; developed and led an NLTK tutorial.

Language Data Analysis *Fall 2021*
Supported undergraduate instruction in linguistic data analysis using R.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Graduate Research Assistant, Douglass Phonetics Lab *Aug 2022 – Jan 2025*
Department of Linguistics, University of Arizona

- Designed and conducted speech perception experiments and analyzed behavioral and acoustic data using R and Python.
- Curated previously collected Dutch and English speech-perception data into two publicly released datasets comprising approximately one million human phonetic-identification responses. University of Arizona Research Data Repository: Dutch DOI; English DOI.
- Mentored undergraduate research assistants in acoustic measurement, speech data analysis, and experimental procedures.

Research Assistant *Sep 2021 – Nov 2021*
Department of English Linguistics, Hankuk University of Foreign Studies
Co-developed phonetic annotation guidelines and led annotation and quality-control activities within a three-annotator team, including cross-review and consensus-based resolution of annotation disagreements.
Sponsored by the Electronics and Telecommunications Research Institute (ETRI), South Korea.

Research Assistant *Feb 2021 – Nov 2021*
Department of English Linguistics, Hankuk University of Foreign Studies
Refined corpora for quality enhancement of machine translation systems.
Sponsored by Hyundai Motor Company, South Korea.

Research Assistant *Sep 2020 – Dec 2020*
Department of English Linguistics, Hankuk University of Foreign Studies
Constructed natural language processing and discourse data for artificial intelligence training.
Sponsored by the National Information Society Agency, South Korea.

Research Assistant *Jun 2020 – Oct 2020*
Department of English Linguistics, Hankuk University of Foreign Studies
Constructed a non-native Korean writing corpus for automated language evaluation.
Sponsored by the Electronics and Telecommunications Research Institute (ETRI), South Korea.

Research Assistant *Mar 2020 – Nov 2020*
Department of English Linguistics, Hankuk University of Foreign Studies
Conducted expert human evaluation of non-native English and Korean speech and extracted features for automated English proficiency assessment.
Sponsored by the Electronics and Telecommunications Research Institute (ETRI), South Korea.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

XRI Global *Jan 2025 – May 2025*
Research Intern

- Fine-tuned and evaluated Whisper-large-v3-turbo ASR models for Urdu, Chichewa, Amharic, and Yoruba using Mozilla Common Voice data.
- Investigated cross-lingual training effects on Chichewa ASR by incorporating Swahili speech data into multilingual fine-tuning.

Hankuk University of Foreign Studies *Aug 2020 – Feb 2022*
Head Assistant, Department of English Linguistics and Language Technology
Coordinated departmental administration related to graduation, internships, exchange programs, and course assignment.

AWARDS, HONORS, AND FUNDING

Kang Dream Foundation Scholarship *May 2026*
Recipient of a graduate scholarship ($1,500).

POMA Student Competition Winner *Dec 2025*
Awarded for *Realization of just: Speech reduction in a high-frequency word* ($300).

Fulbright Graduate Student Program *Feb 2022*
Selected as a Principal Candidate (award declined).

Graduate Work Scholarship, Hankuk University of Foreign Studies *2020 – 2021*

Academic Scholarship (Dean's List), Hankuk University of Foreign Studies *Aug 2019*

International Exchange Scholarship, Hankuk University of Foreign Studies *Aug 2018*

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Guest Lecturer, Osher Lifelong Learning Institute (OLLI) *March 2026*
Why We Don't Say What We Think We Say: Reduced Speech in Everyday Conversation

Manuscript Reviewer, Coyote Papers: Working Papers in Linguistics *2026*
Reviewed a manuscript for the University of Arizona Linguistics Circle publication.

Abstract Reviewer, Arizona Linguistics Circle 18 (ALC18) *2025*
Reviewed five anonymized conference abstracts.

Volunteer, Tucson Festival of Books *March 2024*
Helped children and adults visualize their tongue movements using ultrasound at the Department of Linguistics booth.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Programming *Python, R, Perl, Bash*

Speech & Machine Learning *PyTorch, Hugging Face, Kaldi, Praat*

Tools *Git, GitHub, LaTeX, Linux*

LANGUAGES

Korean (native); English (proficient); Chinese (basic)